Everything Begins & Ends in Brown
2026, A hand-illustrated book on the colour brown, 21 × 21 cm

Context
Brown never got a name of its own. English took it from something dark and dusky, Hindi from a pinch of dust, Bengali from the catechu in a paan, Malayalam from bran. Ask anyone to describe it without the word and they reach for what they know: mud, cocoa, autumn or even rust. This book follows Brown from first memories to the potter's wheel, from a bruised tea leaf to a roadside cup of chai, and asks the question every page leans on: where did you first see it?

This publication is a part of Colour Anthology, a series of small books, each given one colour, written, drawn and curated by the students of Srishti Manipal Institute, under the course Publication Design A. Each book looks at where a colour comes from, what it has meant, and where people meet it in everyday life.

My role
Research, fieldwork, writing, illustration and layout.

Process
I interviewed a potter and a chai seller in Bengaluru and ran an anonymous form asking where people first saw brown. They almost never named the colour, only what it was on, and that became the spine of the book. I tested ten directions before choosing a memory book, then rewrote the text into one flowing voice after feedback.

Outcome
A 28-page book with a dust jacket, drawn entirely by hand. It shows I can turn research and fieldwork into a single, personal story.

Anoti Adele Kinimi

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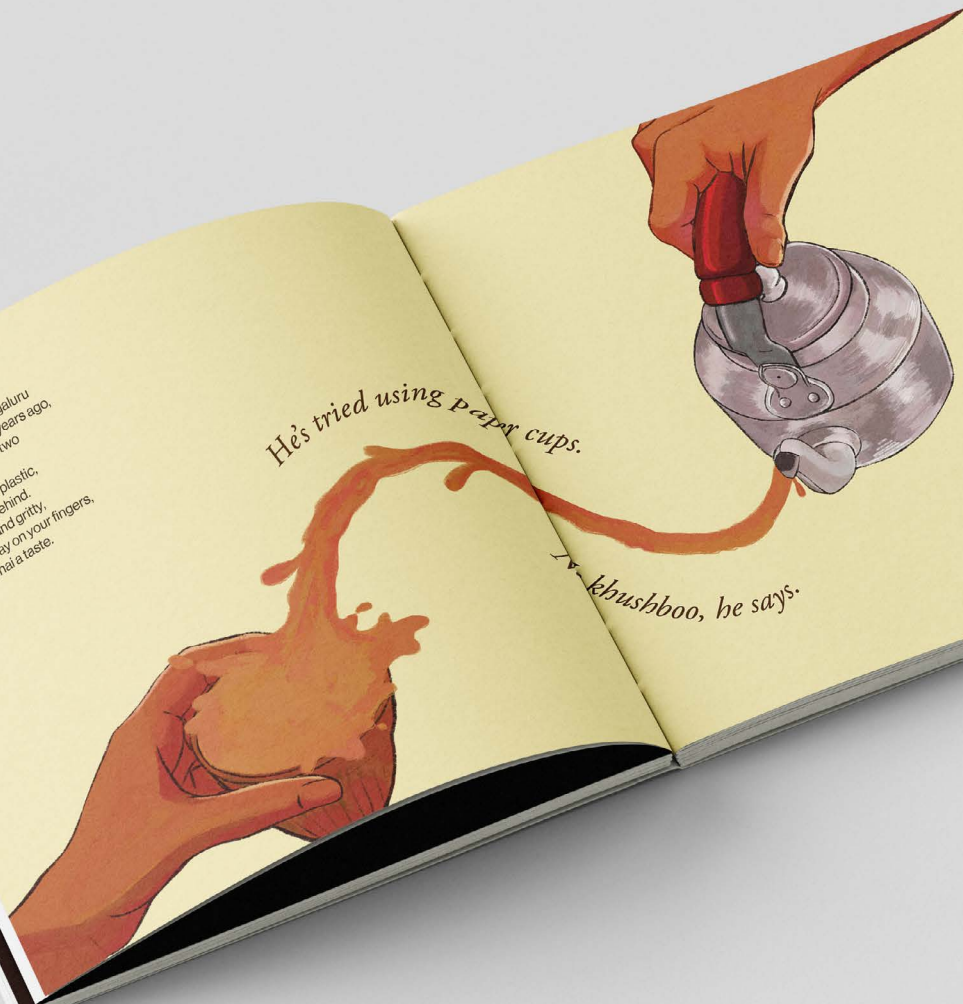

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The chai seller came to Bengaluru
from Kanpur about twelve years ago,
and he'll tell you there are two
kinds of kulhads.
One is smooth, almost plastic,
and leaves nothing behind.
The other is rough and gritty,
you can feel the clay on your fingers,
and it gives the chai a taste.



He's tried using paper cups.

kkhushboo, he says.

Pour chai into a new kulhad,
and it darkens at once.
Customers know what they want:
light *rakhna*, *ekdum kadak*,
dudh bohot mat dalna.
Hardly anyone drinks from clay
every day, and still most people will
tell you chai tastes better in it.

Tea is brown because
the leaf was bruised.
Bruise a green leaf and it
slowly changes its mind,
until it's the colour of
whatever is in your hand.
The British planted the tea
in Assam in 1837.
It took until the early 1900s to
reach ordinary hands,
pushed at railway stations and
factory gates,
and the sellers, who ignored
the proper instructions,
added milk and sugar,
until it became theirs.



Everyone has a different name for
what's in the cup.
Golden amber. Caramel.
Terracotta. Rust.
Muddy water when it rains.

Anoti Adele Kinimi

is a Year 3 student studying in Srishti Manipal Bengaluru.
Everything Begins & Ends in Brown is her book for Colour Anthology, and it began with a simple question she asked friends, family and strangers:
Where did you first see brown?
She is currently interested in pursuing illustration, design, storytelling;
and although she doesn't drink chai,
she's spent a lot of time with the cup.

Brown never got a name of its own. English took it from something dark and dusky, Hindi from a pinch of dust, Bengali from the catechu in a paan, Malayalam from bran. Ask anyone to describe it without the word and they reach for what they know: mud, cocoa, autumn, the rust that warms a face.
This book follows brown from first memories to the potter's wheel, from a bruised tea leaf to a roadside cup of chai, and asks the question every page leans on: where did you first see it?

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Ask someone where they first saw brown and they rarely say the colour. They say mud, walls, soil or crayons. *Everything Begins & Ends in Brown* follows those answers from a potters' street in Bengaluru, where clay turns red in the fire and stays quiet in the air, to a roadside chai stall where a new kulhad darkens the moment tea is poured. Along the way it gathers the names brown has borrowed: dust, bran, cocoa, catechu, soil. Part memory, part field notebook, and drawn throughout, it is a small book about how a colour with no name of its own ends up everywhere.

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Link to the full publication :
https://heyzine.com/flip-book/dfe416ef7a.html